



A legacy unborn

Might & Magic X: Legacy aims at the revival of the classic RPG, but forgets to be interesting in the process <http://dgit.in/mamten>



Ask Digit!

Having tech issues? Check out the Ask Digit Show on youtube for responses to queries <http://dgit.in/askdigit>

'OLX Pe Bech De'

India's e-commerce segment is still at a nascent stage, but the Customer to Customer (C2C) platforms are gaining a lot of popularity. Portals such as OLX and Sulekha have made massive investments in this segment. We had an opportunity to interact with **Amarjit Singh Batra, CEO, OLX India** about the online classifieds segment, hottest categories on OLX, users' response and also how it's dealing with competition.

Kul Bhushan

kul.bhushan@thinkdigit.com

1 How has been the journey so far for OLX.in's journey in Indian e-commerce?

It wasn't easy to create a consumer-to-consumer (C2C) market for used goods in India. The task was hard but the journey of OLX.in has been extraordinary. From a little known brand, today OLX has become the largest used goods marketplace in India with about 850 million page views every month, and growing at a fast pace. Our 'OLX Pe Bech De' tagline has hit a chord across the nation.

2 How many active users/visitors does OLX have? What is your demographic break-up and which is the most active demographic?

OLX has about 850 million page views per month (this includes website and mobile traffic). Interestingly, 62 per cent of OLX traffic is from mobile. This makes us the biggest site in our category, especially because of our focus on C2C. According to the ComScore data, we are the biggest free horizontal online classifieds site in India at 405 million page views in Oct 2013, about 45 per cent bigger than the #2 site.

Users from all age groups are active on OLX. Overall, 65 percent of the users are male while 35 percent are females. According to the latest ComScore data, the largest traffic on OLX is in the age group of 25-34 years, followed by users falling between 18-24 years. Interestingly, users above the age of 50 - 55 years are also quite active on OLX owing to its simplicity and ease of use.

3 How has been the response from Tier 2 and Tier 3 cities? Which cities are the most active on your portal?



Amarjit Singh Batra, CEO, OLX India

The response from Tier 2 and Tier 3 cities is very encouraging because of the growing mobile Internet adoption in India. More than 40 per cent of our traffic is coming from Tier 2 and Tier 3 cities. Since we are focused on C2C segment of used goods, and because of our wide number of categories, we have managed to attract people from all over India to OLX.

4 Which categories (type of products) are the most active on your portal?

The most popular and active categories are that of mobile phones, computer, electronic items, household goods such as furniture, and used cars and bikes. Categories like sports goods, art and collectibles, books and clothing are also fast gaining traction.

Gadgets is the fastest moving category on OLX because of the desire of the consumers to upgrade them often. The top gadgets sold on OLX include mobile phones, cameras, computers, laptops, tablets, video game consoles, and home

appliances like television, refrigerators, air conditioners, oven to even hair driers and ceiling fans.

5 A marketplace or retailer – which is a better concept? Do you see them co-exist?

I'm a big believer in the marketplace model. It is the most scalable and low touch model but it also has its challenges. At OLX, we follow the marketplace model and we are an open marketplace so anyone can sell and buy here. The content on our website is hundred percent user generated and we don't mediate between the buyer and the seller.

6 What is your strategy to compete with the competition and traditional 'classifieds'? Please provide some figures.

In the last one year our page views have grown at nearly 400 per cent, our listings by more than 400 per cent, and our visits by almost 200 per cent. We have established ourselves as the market leader and are growing at a phenomenal pace. We focus on the C2C market whereas our competitors, including the traditional classifieds, are focusing on B2C classifieds. Our strategy is to keep growing in a way that helps C2C percolate down to the masses in remotest parts of the country, making people's lives easier.

7 What are future plans of OLX?

OLX has seen tremendous growth in the last year and expects to increase manifold in the next year. We will continue to focus on diverse and new demographics in the coming year. With the increase in penetration of mobile internet, a large part of our focus will be on the mobile, which is a challenging and difficult space to survive in. 